

US Live Shopping Just Broke Out

After two years of decline, search interest for live shopping surged in 2025.

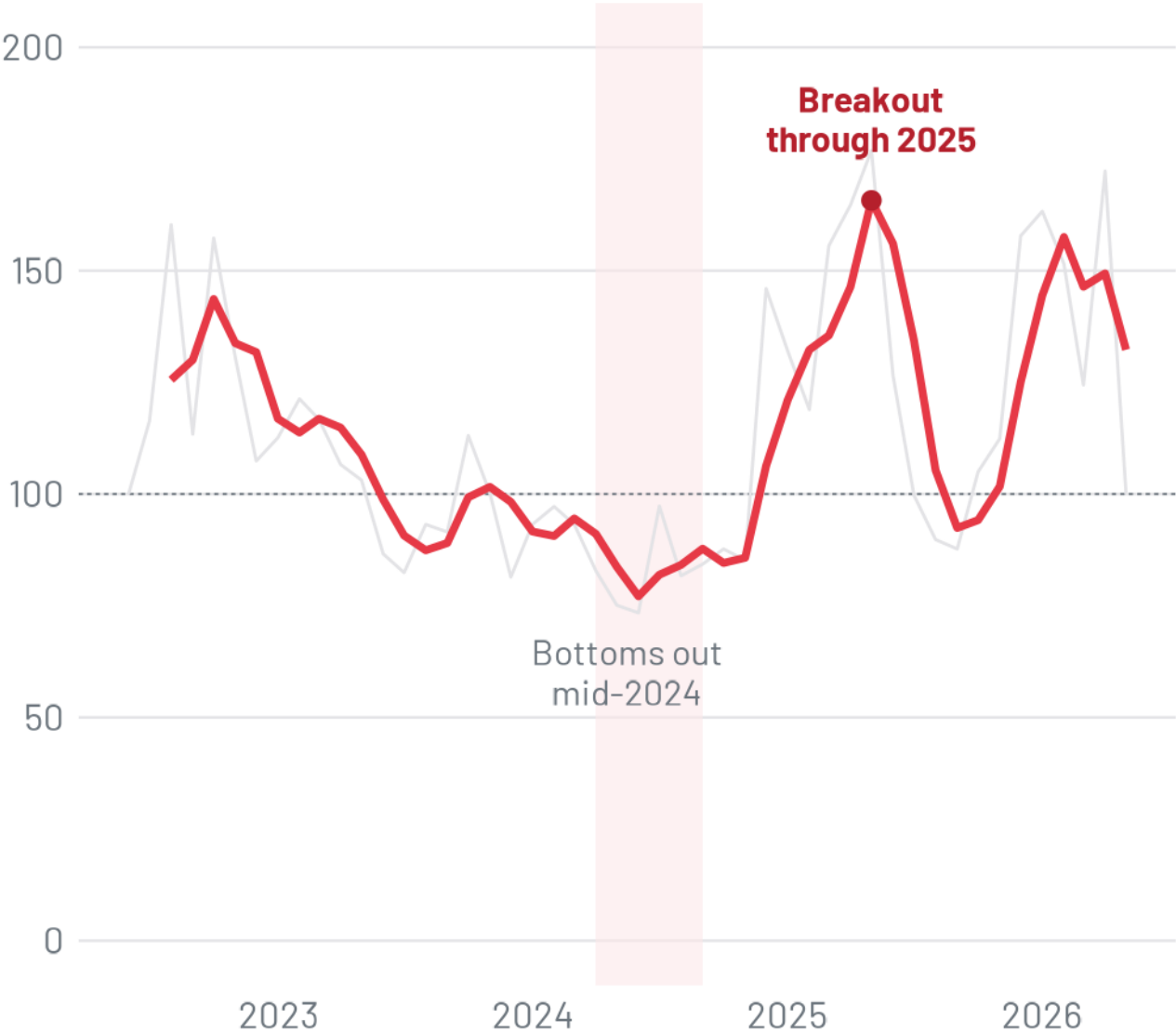
+39%

growth in average monthly searches, 2025 vs 2024

THE TREND

Two Years Down, Then a Surge

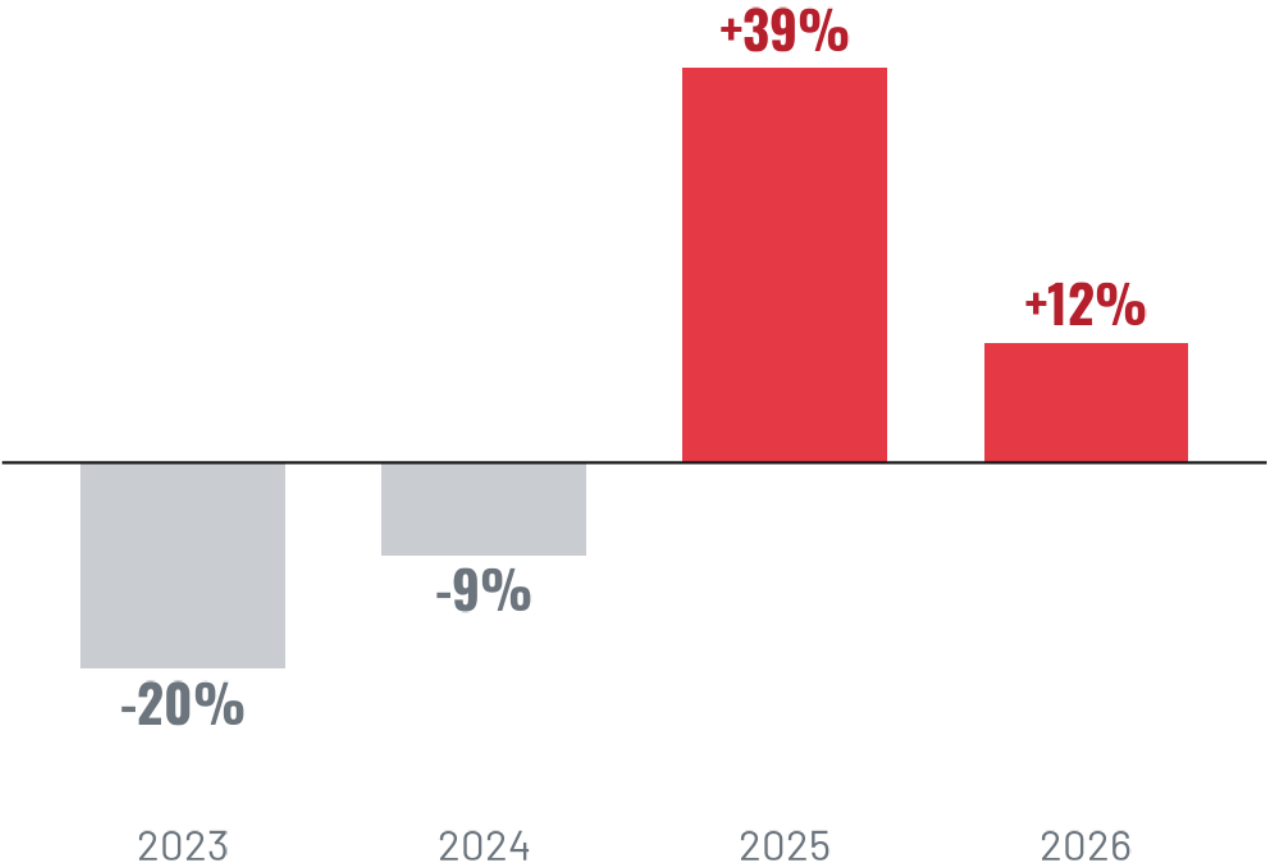
Search-interest index, 100 = June 2022. 3-month average.



THE REVERSAL

The Decline Snapped in 2025

Year-over-year change in average monthly search interest.



THE TELL

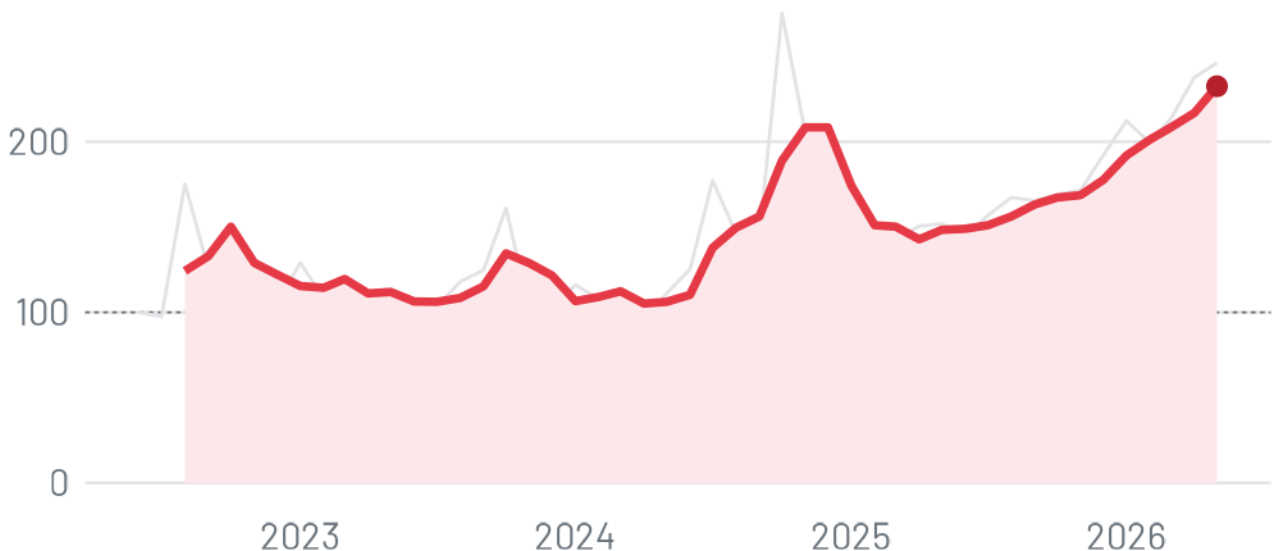
Sellers Move First

Seller-side search ("how to sell on whatnot," "tiktok shop seller center") leads consumer interest – an early warning.

~6 mo

the live-selling index
leads live shopping –
about two quarters early

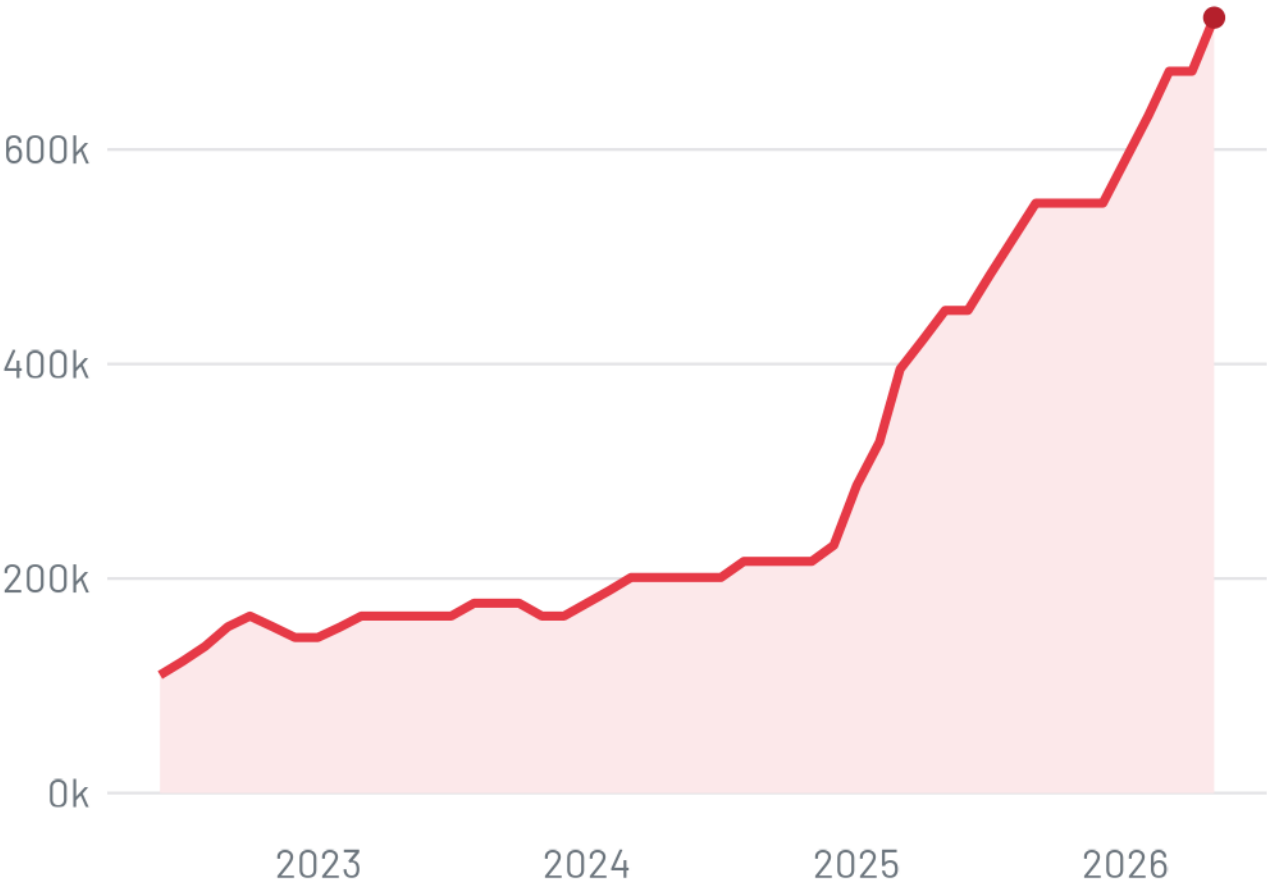
Supply-side search is up +133% since 2022 – it runs hotter than demand.



Whatnot Keeps Climbing

Monthly US searches for “whatnot,” 3-month average.

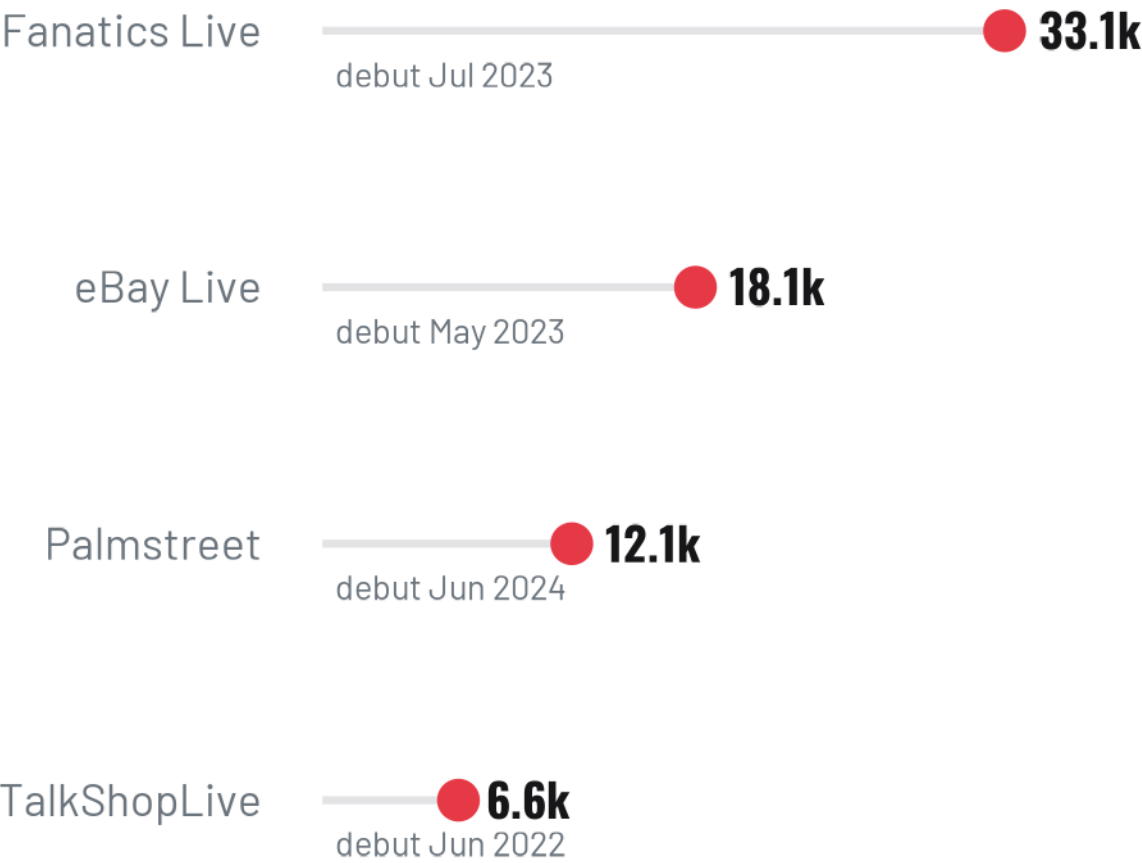
6.6x growth in 3 years — now at its highest level on record



NEW ENTRANTS

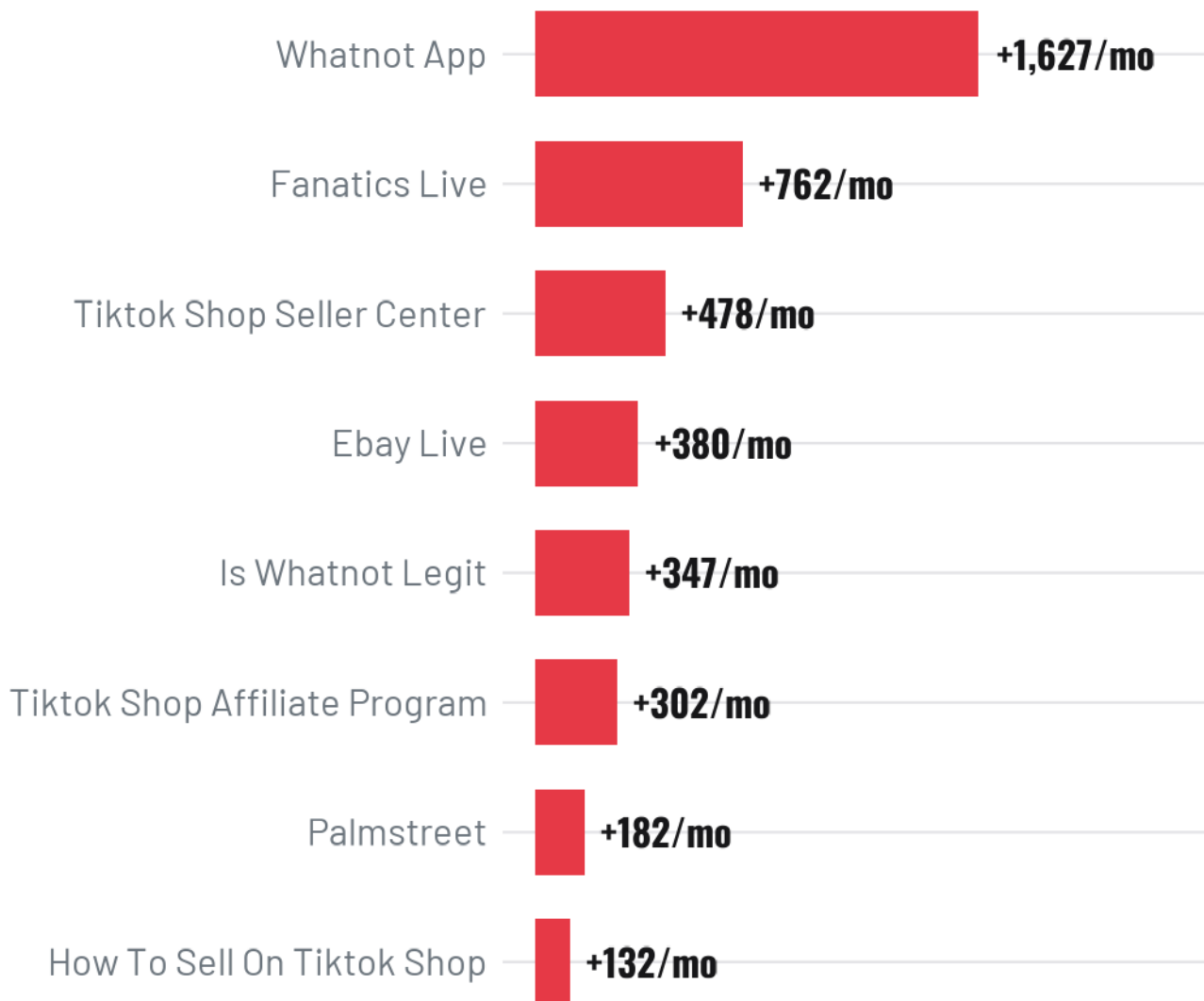
A Wave of New Live-Selling Apps

Challenger platforms, peak monthly US search interest.



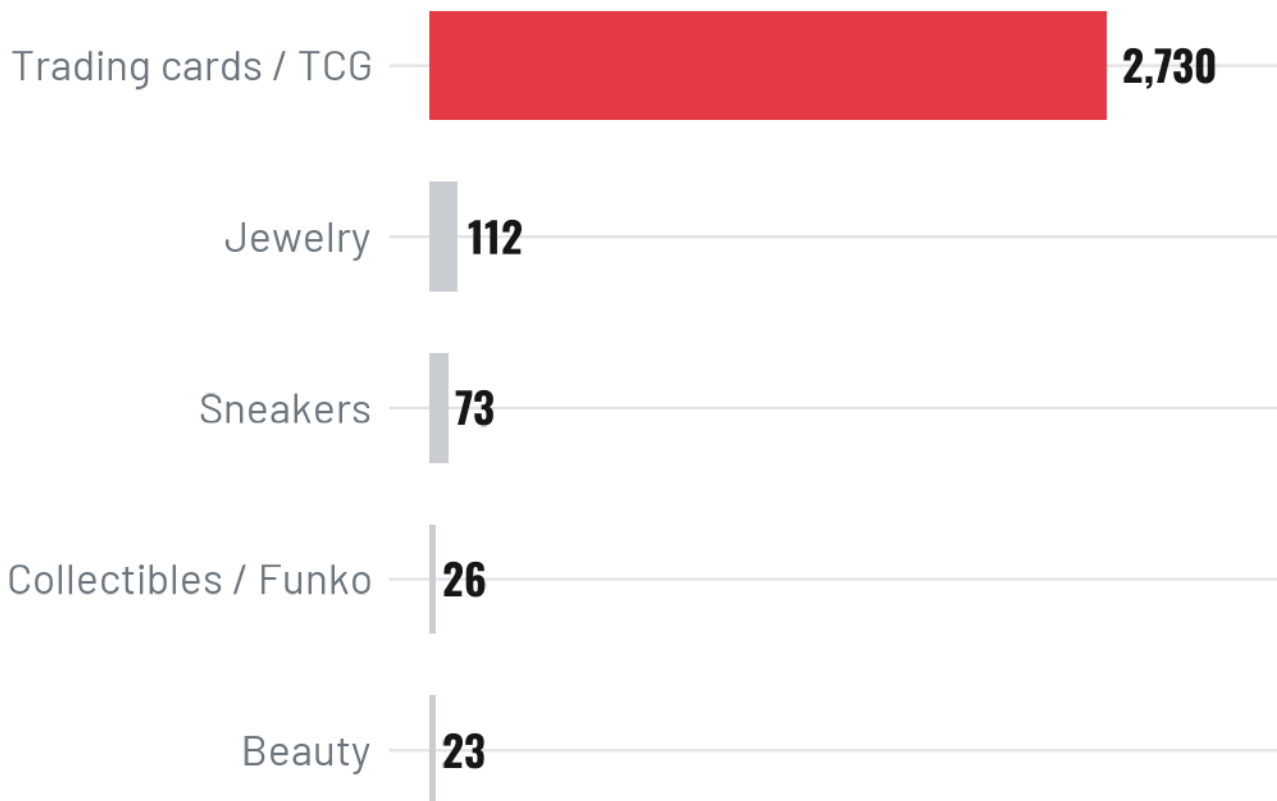
The Fastest-Growing Queries

Monthly searches added per month (trend slope).



Trading Cards Run the Category

Avg. monthly live-shopping search interest by vertical.



Trading cards draw ~24× the search of the next vertical.

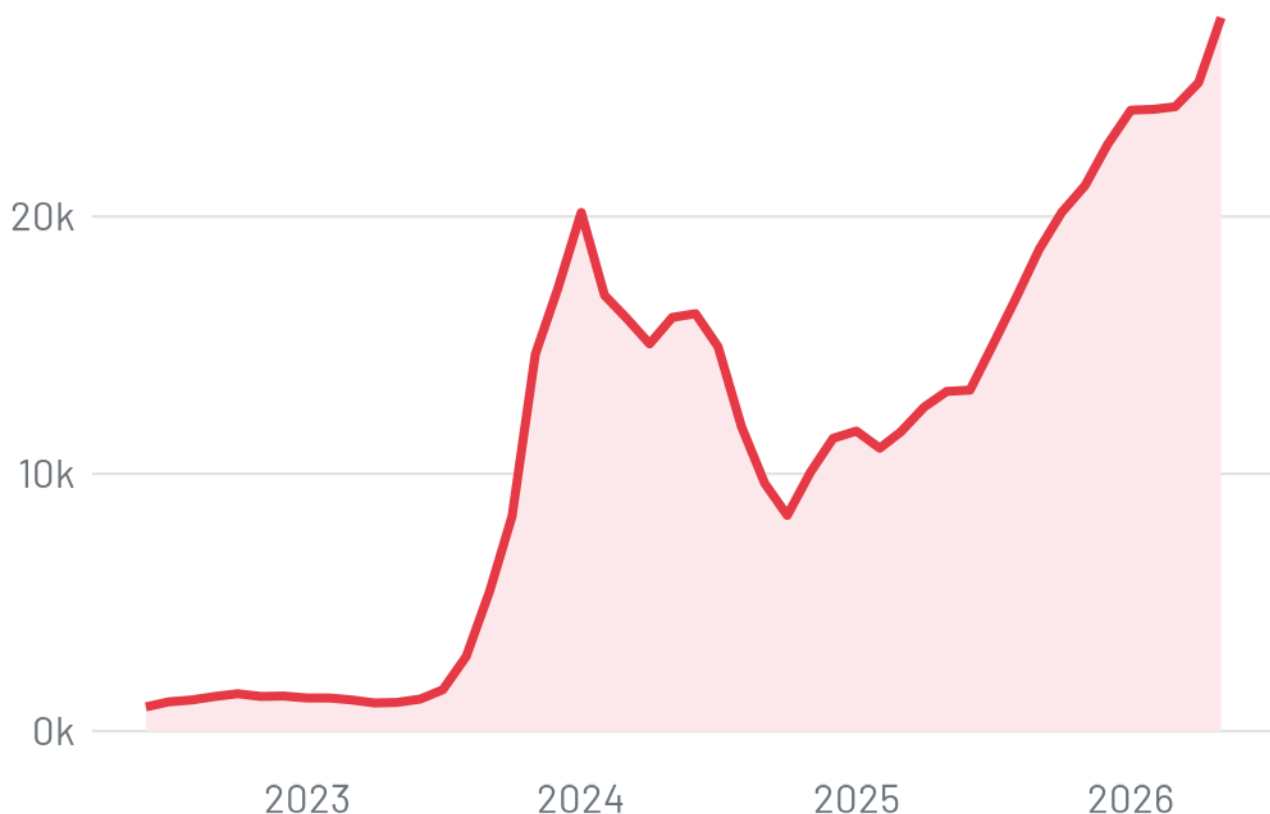
GOING MAINSTREAM

Now Everyone Asks: Is It Legit?

Monthly searches for “is whatnot legit,” “is tiktok shop legit.”

~**30x**

more trust-checking searches —
a sign the category has gone
mainstream



Source: Google Ads Keyword Planner, US, Jun 2022–May 2026 · ~79k keywords

LIVE SHOPPING INDEX

THE TAKEAWAY

What This Means

US live shopping has moved from a post-pandemic slump to a genuine breakout.

- Category search interest rose ~39% in 2025.
- Sellers move first — supply-side search leads by ~2 quarters.
- Whatnot keeps growing — up 6.6× in three years.
- Trading cards lead; trust is going mainstream.

Alex Papageorgiou

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